

Task: Build a Vehicle Rental Management Backend

Objective

Build a small REST API for a vehicle rental company. Staff log in and manage the vehicle fleet; customer bookings are recorded as rentals. A vehicle can't be booked twice for overlapping dates. Provide a monthly report of rental activity per vehicle.

Requirements

1. Environment Setup

- Node.js + TypeScript project, OOP structure — services/classes, not everything crammed into route handlers
- Express as the web framework
- Knex as the query builder
- PostgreSQL (preferred) or MySQL — either way you'll need real SQL, not just Knex's chain syntax
- Joi or express-validator for input validation
- ESLint + Prettier configured
- .env for DB credentials, JWT secret, upload path, and port — gitignored, with a committed .env.example
- Multer (or similar) for local photo storage

2. Database Schema

staff

- id (PK, auto-increment)
- email (unique, required)
- password_hash (required)
- name (required)
- created_at, updated_at

vehicles

- id (PK, auto-increment)
- name (required)
- plate_number (unique, required)
- category (required)
- daily_rate (decimal, required)
- photo_path (optional)
- deleted_at (nullable)
- created_at, updated_at

rentals

- id (PK, auto-increment)
- vehicle_id (FK → vehicles.id, required)
- customer_name (required)
- customer_phone (required)
- start_date (date, required)
- end_date (date, required)
- total_amount (decimal, required)
- status (booked / ongoing / completed / cancelled — default booked)
- created_at, updated_at

Note: there's no column-level constraint that stops double-booking — two rentals only conflict if their date ranges actually overlap and both are active. That check belongs in your application code, on both create and update.

3. Authentication

- POST /auth/login — email + password → JWT
- JWT middleware protects every /vehicles, /rentals, and /reports route

4. Endpoints

Auth

- POST /auth/login

Vehicles

- GET /vehicles — pagination, filter by category, search by name
- GET /vehicles/:id
- POST /vehicles — multipart form-data with photo
- PUT /vehicles/:id — including photo replacement
- DELETE /vehicles/:id — soft delete

Rentals

- GET /rentals — filter by vehicle_id, status, and date range
- GET /rentals/:id
- POST /rentals — body: vehicle_id, customer_name, customer_phone, start_date, end_date
 - 409 if the vehicle already has an active rental overlapping these dates
 - total_amount is calculated server-side — daily_rate × number of days (same start/end date counts as 1 day)
- PUT /rentals/:id — date changes re-trigger the overlap check
- DELETE /rentals/:id

Reports

- GET /reports/rentals?month=YYYY-MM — optional &vehicle_id=
 - per vehicle — id, name, total_bookings, days_rented, revenue
 - only count days/revenue that fall inside the requested month — a rental running July 29–Aug 3 contributes 3 days to the August report, not 6
 - also return the vehicle with the highest revenue that month

5. TypeScript

- Type every request body, response, and handler return value
- Extend Express's Request type with the decoded JWT payload

6. Database Connection

- pg or mysql2 behind a Knex connection pool; pool size and credentials from env vars
- Migrations + seeds — seed at least one rental that spans a month boundary so the report is actually testable

Bonus (Optional)

- Wrap the availability check and insert in a transaction, so two people booking the same vehicle at the same moment can't both succeed
- Pagination/search on /rentals as well
- Basic rate limiting on /auth/login

Deliverables

- Public Git repository

- README with setup and run instructions
- .env.example
- Migration files — schema should build cleanly on an empty database

You should be ready to walk through your overlap and report queries and explain why they're correct — that's part of the review.